



MEDICATION RISK REPORT · MARCH 19, 2026

Query: I take Theraflu twice a day and Tylenol 3 times a day, and I drink wine every night



High Risk

You are taking too much acetaminophen and combining it with alcohol, which creates a serious risk of liver damage. Both Theraflu and Tylenol contain acetaminophen, and together they exceed safe daily limits.

RISK DETAILS

1. Acetaminophen dose exceeds safe daily limit

Both Theraflu and Tylenol contain acetaminophen. Together you're taking 3,500 mg per day, which exceeds the safe limit of 3,000 mg. Taking too much acetaminophen can cause severe liver damage, even if you feel fine at first. The liver damage can be permanent and life-threatening.

Source: Dose accumulation analysis

2. Acetaminophen combined with alcohol

Mixing acetaminophen with alcohol dramatically increases your risk of liver damage. Even moderate drinking while taking acetaminophen can harm your liver. If you drink three or more alcoholic drinks daily, acetaminophen becomes dangerous even at normal doses because your liver cannot safely process both substances at once.

Source: DrugBank interaction database

3. Dextromethorphan (in Theraflu) combined with alcohol

The dextromethorphan in Theraflu mixed with alcohol causes extreme drowsiness, confusion, and dangerous slowing of your breathing. This combination significantly increases your risk of falls and accidents, and impairs your judgment and coordination much more than either substance alone.

Source: DrugBank interaction database

WHAT TO DO

Stop taking one of these products immediately — you only need one source of acetaminophen, not both. If you need both fever relief and cold symptom relief, choose either Theraflu or Tylenol, but not both at the same time. Read labels carefully: many cold and flu products contain acetaminophen, so never combine them. Do not drink any alcohol while taking these medications. Wait at least 6 to 8 hours after your last dose of Theraflu before having any alcoholic drinks. If you regularly drink three or more alcoholic drinks per day, do not take acetaminophen at all without talking to a doctor first — consider ibuprofen (Advil, Motrin) as an alternative pain reliever, but ask a pharmacist whether it's safe for you given your alcohol use.

‡ **Speak with a pharmacist or doctor** before continuing this combination.

SOURCES

OpenFDA label: 'Theraflu'

[https://api.fda.gov/drug/label.json?search=openfda.brand_name:\"Theraflu\"&limit=1](https://api.fda.gov/drug/label.json?search=openfda.brand_name:\)

RxNorm: 'Tylenol' (RxCUI 202433)

<https://rxnav.nlm.nih.gov/REST/rxcui/202433/allrelated.json>

OpenFDA label: 'Tylenol'

[https://api.fda.gov/drug/label.json?search=openfda.brand_name:\"Tylenol\"&limit=1](https://api.fda.gov/drug/label.json?search=openfda.brand_name:\)

LLM pharmacological reasoning (Claude)

<https://www.anthropic.com>

FDA OTC safe daily dose limits (monograph + label guidance)

<https://www.fda.gov/drugs/drug-safety-and-availability/questions-and-answers-information-acetaminophen-prescription-drug-products-required-liver-warning>

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